

Dhāraṇī of Avalokiteśvara, the Noble Bodhisattva Great Being Endowed with Great Compassion

Avalokiteśvara Dhāraṇī · Toh 713 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སྒྲ་རས་གཟགིས་དབང་ཕྱུག

Toh 713 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text dedicated to Avalokiteśvara, the noble bodhisattva of great compassion, known in Sanskrit as Avalokiteśvara and in Tibetan as Phags pa Spyan ras gzigs dbang phyug. The text presents a dhāraṇī — a sacred mantra-formula — along with a brief practical instruction for its use, combining the recitation of the mantra with a preparation of brahmin herb, ghee, and milk to be taken over seven days as a means of strengthening memory and retaining what one has heard. It belongs to the broader category of dhāraṇī and mantra literature within the Kangyur, texts focused on the ritual and contemplative power of sacred formulas. The opening notation that "the hundred ślokas have been fully mastered" suggests that this text was transmitted alongside or as a complement to a larger collection of verses, reflecting the compact, practical orientation characteristic of dhāraṇī literature in the Buddhist canonical tradition.

...they too shall not forget. The hundred ślokas have been fully mastered.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the noble bodhisattva, the great being endowed with great compassion, Avalokiteśvara, Lord of the Seen.

Bīre bīre, matite je, teja matī dhāraṇī, śruta dhāraṇī, jayanti vijayanti matī dhāraṇī svāhā.

Take brahmin herb and ghi, grind them finely together, and boil them in milk. Recite this mantra twenty-one times, and if one drinks it for seven days, one will without fail come to retain what one has heard.

Translator's Notes

- The passage opens mid-sentence, completing a statement about not forgetting, followed by a colophon marking the completion of a hundred-śloka memorization text. The mantra transcription follows Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit syllables and is given here as faithfully reconstructed. The two medicinal ingredients rendered as "brahmin herb and ghi" correspond to the Tibetan "sman bram" (a plant, possibly Brahmi, *Bacopa monnieri*, often associated with memory enhancement in Indo-Tibetan medical tradition) and "zhol" or "ghi" — the precise identification of the first ingredient is uncertain, though the pairing with milk and the mnemonic context strongly suggests a Brahmi-based memory preparation. The phrase "lord of the seen" glosses dbang phyug, meaning "lord," combined with spyan ras gzigs, the

Tibetan rendering of Avalokiteśvara.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.